

AetherCloud Privacy & Data Governance Policy

Synthetic controlled test document for PolarisLex

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This document is wholly synthetic and is intended for adversarial legal-policy parsing, reference-resolution, knowledge-graph construction, and compliance-reasoning tests. It does not describe a real company or reproduce an existing privacy policy.

1. Introduction and Scope

AetherCloud provides hosted collaboration, storage, workflow, and analytical services to organizations and individual users. This Policy governs Personal Information processed by AetherCloud, its Affiliates, and approved Service Providers in connection with an Essential Service, an Authorized Purpose, or a Secondary Purpose. The classifications in Appendix A, retention rules in Appendix B, and purpose identifiers in Appendix C are incorporated into this Policy where the text expressly refers to them.

This Policy applies to information collected through digital services, support, connected devices, and permitted offline interactions, whether AetherCloud acts as controller, principal, Processor, or Service Provider. A customer agreement cannot authorize conduct prohibited by Sections 6, 8, 10, 13, 14, 16, or 19; a stricter customer requirement controls subject to Section 20.4.

This Policy does not govern information that is demonstrably Anonymized Information, except where re-identification, combination with Personal Information, or a contractual restriction causes the information to regain a regulated character. It also does not govern employment records maintained solely for AetherCloud personnel, unless those records are combined with account, security, or service data for an Authorized Purpose.

2. Definitions

For this Policy, the following terms have the meanings below. A capitalized term has the meaning in this Section unless a later, narrower provision expressly states otherwise.

2.1 “Personal Information” means information relating to an identified or reasonably identifiable natural person, including Account Data, Contact Data, Device Data, Behavioral

Data, User-Generated Content, and Derived Information when the latter can reasonably be linked to a person.

2.2 “Sensitive Information” means Personal Information revealing authentication secrets, precise location, health-related context, financial account details, biometric templates, children’s data, or information that Appendix A marks “Sensitive.”

2.3 “Restricted Information” means the subset of Sensitive Information that Appendix A marks “Restricted,” together with unredacted government identifiers, payment credentials, recovery codes, and security material designated Restricted under Section 15.2.

2.4 “Pseudonymous Information” means Personal Information separated from direct identifiers by a token, key, or equivalent substitute, where AetherCloud or another party could reasonably reconnect the information.

2.5 “Anonymized Information” means information processed so that AetherCloud reasonably determines that a person is not identifiable, directly or indirectly, taking account of reasonably available means; information is not Anonymized Information merely because names were removed.

2.6 “Derived Information” means information generated from Personal Information or Pseudonymous Information through analytical, statistical, inferential, or machine-learning processes. Derived Information inherits the most protective classification of its linkable source unless Appendix A expressly assigns a lower classification after validation.

2.7 “Account Data” means registration, subscription, authentication, role, billing-contact, and account-administration information.

2.8 “Behavioral Data” means interaction events, feature usage, click paths, preference signals, and inferred interests associated with a user, device, workspace, or token.

2.9 “User-Generated Content” means files, messages, prompts, comments, recordings, images, and other material submitted, stored, or transmitted by a user.

2.10 “Service Provider” means a party that processes Personal Information solely on AetherCloud’s documented instructions for an Authorized Purpose and that is bound by restrictions no less protective than Sections 8 and 9.

2.11 “Processor” means an entity processing Personal Information on behalf of another entity. A Service Provider is a Processor for the relevant activity, but a Processor is not necessarily a Service Provider if it determines an independent purpose.

2.12 “Affiliate” means an entity controlling, controlled by, or under common control with AetherCloud, provided that the entity is recorded in the governance register and follows this Policy or a stricter equivalent.

2.13 “Authorized Purpose” means a purpose listed in Appendix C as permitted for the relevant data category, legal basis, geography, retention period, and sharing conditions.

2.14 “Secondary Purpose” means Product Improvement, Analytics, Research, Personalization, Advertising, or another use that is not necessary to provide the requested Essential Service.

2.15 “Essential Service” means account access, requested storage or collaboration, service security, billing, support, reliability, and legally required administration, but excludes Advertising and optional Personalization.

2.16 “High-Risk Processing” means processing classified as high risk under Section 13 and further identified in Appendix C, including eligibility decisions, risk scoring with material effects, sensitive-data personalization, and automated denial or restriction of access.

2.17 “Regulatory Request” means a request, order, demand, audit notice, or compulsory process from a governmental, judicial, supervisory, or law-enforcement authority.

2.18 “Legal Hold” means a documented preservation instruction under Section 11.4 that temporarily suspends ordinary deletion for a defined matter and scope.

2.19 “Effective Date” means the date on which the applicable version or amendment begins to govern prospective processing. “At the time of collection” refers to the rule effective when the relevant record was collected, subject to Section 11.5.

2.20 “Applicable Regional Privacy Law” means a privacy, data-protection, consumer-protection, employment, communications, or sector rule applicable to the relevant person, processing activity, or jurisdiction. This synthetic definition does not attempt to state any real law.

3. Information We Collect

AetherCloud collects Account Data such as names, business roles, login details, workspace identifiers, subscription selections, and billing contacts. It collects Contact Data, including email addresses, telephone numbers, support correspondence, and delivery preferences. Payment tokens, transaction references, and limited billing information may be collected, while full payment credentials are normally handled by a specialized payment Service Provider.

AetherCloud collects Device Data, including IP address, operating system, browser characteristics, device identifiers, approximate location, diagnostic events, and network information. Behavioral Data records use of features and may be linked to Account Data, a device, or a Pseudonymous Information token. User-Generated Content is collected when a user submits it to an Essential Service; AetherCloud does not treat the content as non-personal merely because it was supplied by a customer organization.

Sensitive Information may arise in User-Generated Content, support records, security events, or connected services. Restricted Information is collected only where reasonably necessary for an Authorized Purpose, except where Section 16.2 requires limited preservation or disclosure. Derived Information may include reliability forecasts, abuse indicators, preference inferences, or aggregated service metrics, but the classification rule in Section 2.6 applies notwithstanding a model's output format.

4. Sources of Information

AetherCloud receives information directly from users, administrators, customers, and authorized representatives. It also receives information automatically from devices, browsers, applications, cookies, logs, and sensors, subject to Section 17. Affiliates and Service Providers may supply information for the purposes in Appendix C, provided that the transfer satisfies Section 8.4 and Section 10.4.

AetherCloud may receive information from identity, fraud, payment, communications, and integration partners. It may use such information for P2 or P3 only when the source, purpose, and category are authorized in Appendix C and Appendix A. Public information may support P7 or P9 unless it is Sensitive Information, an applicable objection must be honored, or Section 6.4 requires consent.

5. Purposes of Processing

AetherCloud processes Personal Information for P1 Service Delivery, P2 Security, P3 Fraud Prevention, P4 Personalization, P5 Advertising, P6 Analytics, P7 Product Improvement, P8 Legal Compliance, P9 Research, and P10 Automated Decision-Making. Each purpose is constrained by the relationships in Appendix C; naming a purpose in this Section does not itself authorize every data category.

P1 and P2 are ordinarily Essential Services. P3 may be essential where needed to protect users, accounts, systems, or transactions. P4 through P7 and P9 are Secondary Purposes unless a customer has expressly configured them as part of an Essential Service. P10 is permitted only with the safeguards in Section 13, even where its input purpose is P2 or P3. Processing for a purpose not listed in Appendix C is prohibited unless a later amendment expressly adds it under Section 18.

6. Legal Bases and Consent

AetherCloud may process data for P1 where necessary to perform a requested service, for P2 and P3 where reasonably necessary to protect the service or prevent misuse, and for P8 where required to comply with an Applicable Regional Privacy Law or Regulatory Request. These bases do not override a regional consent or prohibition rule in Section 19.

Consent is required for P4, P5, or P9 when Appendix C marks consent “Yes,” unless a regional provision supplies a narrower exception. Consent must be specific to the stated purpose and data category; consent to an Essential Service is not consent to Advertising. Withdrawal must be as easy as giving consent, except that withdrawal does not invalidate prior lawful processing and does not require deletion where Section 11.4 or Section 16.2 applies.

Sensitive Information may be processed for a Secondary Purpose only where the data category, purpose, legal basis, consent flag, geography, and sharing condition in Appendix C are all satisfied. Restricted Information may be processed only for P1, P2, P3, or P8, unless Section 19.1 expressly permits a narrower regional variation. A condition in this paragraph is cumulative, not alternative.

Consent from a customer administrator is effective for organization-controlled settings only to the extent the administrator is authorized, the notice reaches affected users where required, and Section 14’ s children’ s rules are satisfied. A statement that processing is “enabled by default” is not evidence of consent where Appendix C requires affirmative consent.

7. Use of Personal Information

AetherCloud uses Account Data and Contact Data to create accounts, authenticate users, provide support, administer subscriptions, and communicate service notices. Use for P1 is subject to the minimization and retention limits in Sections 11.1 and 11.2. Notwithstanding Section 7.1, a support message containing Sensitive Information may be routed to a restricted support queue only where necessary to resolve the request and where access controls under Section 15.2 are applied.

AetherCloud may use Device Data and Behavioral Data for P2 and P3 where the signals are reasonably necessary to detect compromise, abuse, or service degradation. A security signal may be retained under Appendix B even if the associated account is deleted, but only for the security period and only in Pseudonymous Information form where the identity is not needed. This rule is subject to a Legal Hold under Section 11.4.

AetherCloud may use Derived Information for P7 only where the underlying source data is eligible for P7 under Appendix C, the output does not recreate Restricted Information, and the retention period does not exceed the controlling entry in Appendix B. A model output is not Anonymized Information merely because it contains a score. Where Section 2.6 classifies the output as Personal Information, Sections 6, 11, and 12 continue to apply.

Personalization under P4 may use Behavioral Data only when consent is recorded where required, the user can disable the feature, and no Restricted Information is used as an input. Sensitive Information may be used for Personalization only where the conditions in

Sections 6.4 and 13.2 are simultaneously satisfied; a user's general account consent is insufficient. Advertising under P5 may not use Restricted Information, children's data, precise location, or eligibility scores, except that an anonymized audience count may be used after validation under Appendix A.

8. Disclosure and Sharing

AetherCloud may disclose Personal Information to Affiliates for an Authorized Purpose when the recipient is bound by this Policy, access is limited by role, and the disclosure is recorded. An Affiliate may not convert P1 data into its own Advertising database unless Appendix C permits P5 and the consent and regional conditions are satisfied. The more specific restriction controls over the general Affiliate permission under Section 20.1.

AetherCloud may disclose information to a Service Provider only under Section 9, and may disclose information to a customer administrator only to operate the customer's workspace or respond to a verified request. A disclosure to a customer administrator does not authorize the administrator to export Restricted Information where Section 19 imposes a regional prohibition.

AetherCloud may disclose information in a merger, financing, restructuring, or asset transfer only where the recipient accepts this Policy's applicable restrictions, the disclosure is limited to a documented transaction purpose, and the recipient does not begin a new Secondary Purpose before providing any required notice or obtaining consent. This paragraph does not permit a transfer of Restricted Information if Section 10.4 or Section 19.1 forbids the transfer.

A disclosure to a Service Provider under Section 8.4 is valid only if Section 9.2's audit, deletion, onward-transfer, and confidentiality conditions are met, and Section 2.10 confirms that the recipient is acting solely as a Service Provider. Thus, Section 8.4 → Section 9.2 → Section 2.10 → Appendix A forms a multi-hop classification chain.

9. Service Providers and Processors

A Service Provider may process only the categories, purposes, and territories stated in its agreement. It must apply reasonable administrative, technical, and physical safeguards, notify AetherCloud of a suspected incident, assist with rights requests, return or delete data at the end of the service, and use a subprocessor only with documented authorization. It may not sell, advertise from, or combine the data with another customer's data unless expressly authorized as a separate Authorized Purpose.

Before appointment, AetherCloud assesses the provider's role under Section 2.11, checks Appendix A, and records Appendix B's retention dependency. A provider handling Restricted Information must use a restricted environment, named personnel, access

logging, and deletion verification. Notwithstanding Section 9.1, it may retain a segregated minimal security record for legal defense only where Section 11.4 authorizes a Legal Hold.

A Processor receiving Pseudonymous Information must not seek to reverse the token unless the agreement and an Authorized Purpose expressly require linkage. If linkage is required for P1, the Processor must destroy the linkage material when the purpose ends, except where Section 16.2 requires preservation. A contract that labels a party a “vendor” does not determine its legal role; the functional definition in Section 2 controls unless the agreement expressly imposes a narrower meaning.

10. International Data Transfers

AetherCloud may transfer Personal Information across borders for P1–P10 only where the receiving location, category, purpose, and safeguards are permitted by Appendix C and the transfer mechanism is documented. Transfers of Restricted Information require encryption in transit and at rest, a documented access necessity, and the additional regional requirements in Section 19.

Before a cross-border transfer, AetherCloud records source, destination, recipient role, classification, purpose ID, retention, and deletion path. Affiliate status alone does not validate a transfer; conflicts with a source-region restriction are resolved under Sections 16 and 19.

P4, P5, and P9 transfers require the consent status specified in Appendix C, even when P1 data is included in the same export. A mixed export must be split or treated according to its most restrictive category unless a documented technical control isolates the categories. Provided that the requirements of Section 10.4 are met, Pseudonymous Information may be transferred for P6 or P7; otherwise the transfer is prohibited.

11. Retention and Deletion

Personal Information is retained according to Appendix B, not according to an informal operational practice. The applicable period is selected by data category and purpose, then adjusted by a valid exception, regional override, or Legal Hold. Where two entries appear to conflict, the narrower category, more specific purpose, later amendment, and incorporated appendix rule are applied in the order stated in Section 20.

Version 3.0 permitted a 24-month default for Account Data. Version 3.1, effective 1 April 2026, reduced P1 Account Data to 18 months and added a 24-month exception for unresolved billing disputes. Version 3.2, effective 15 August 2026, replaced Section 11.2 and reduced ordinary P1 Account Data to 12 months; the billing-dispute exception remains 24 months only while the dispute is documented. References to the former 24-month

retention period must therefore be interpreted as references to the 12-month period in amended Section 11.2 unless the specific billing-dispute exception applies.

Information collected before the Effective Date remains subject to the retention requirements applicable at the time of collection, except where Section 11.5 requires reclassification. Section 11.5 requires reclassification when new information shows that data previously treated as ordinary Personal Information is Sensitive or Restricted, or when a model output becomes linkable to an identified person. Reclassification applies from the validation date and does not retroactively authorize a past use.

A Legal Hold may suspend deletion only for the defined data, matter, and duration. A Legal Hold does not authorize new processing, general access, or indefinite preservation. If Section 16.2 requires preservation of Restricted Information for a valid legal request, the hold is limited to the requested scope and reviewed every 90 days. Where law requires a longer period than Appendix B, the legal period controls only for the affected record.

Deletion means removal from active systems and scheduled removal from recoverable copies. Backups may remain for the shortest technically necessary cycle, provided they are isolated, inaccessible for ordinary use, and deleted on the backup schedule. Account deletion does not erase transaction records required by P8, security records required by P2, or content preserved under Section 16.2; however, those exceptions do not preserve unrelated Behavioral Data.

12. User Rights

Subject to verification, a user may request access, correction, deletion, portability, restriction, objection, or withdrawal of consent as applicable to the relevant region and purpose. A request concerning User-Generated Content may be answered through the customer administrator where the customer controls the workspace, unless a regional provision in Section 19 grants a direct right against AetherCloud.

AetherCloud may narrow a request only as reasonably necessary to protect another person, preserve a Legal Hold, prevent fraud, comply with a Regulatory Request, or maintain security. It must identify the exception without exposing protected investigation details. Derived Information remains in scope under Section 2.6; validated Anonymized Information is excluded unless validation is challenged successfully.

Deletion and objection requests affect future processing promptly where technically feasible, but they do not require deletion of data retained under Sections 11.4, 11.5, or 16.2. Withdrawal of consent stops the associated Secondary Purpose; it does not automatically stop P1, P2, P3, or P8 when another valid basis applies. Appeals of a denied request are reviewed by personnel independent of the original decision where Section 13.4 applies.

13. Automated Decision-Making and Profiling

AetherCloud may use automated systems for service reliability, spam filtering, fraud detection, security alert prioritization, and non-material personalization. P10 risk scoring is High-Risk Processing when it can materially affect eligibility, access, price, account standing, or a person's opportunity to use an Essential Service. A score used only to rank alerts for human investigation is not by itself a final eligibility decision.

High-Risk Processing may use Sensitive Information only where Section 6.4 is satisfied, the input categories are authorized in Appendix C, the model is tested for material error, and a human reviewer can examine the principal factors. Restricted Information may be used for P10 fraud detection only when necessary to address a specific security event, access is logged, the retention period follows Appendix B, and Section 15.2 controls are applied. Personalization cannot be recharacterized as fraud prevention merely by changing the label of the workflow.

A person subject to an adverse eligibility or access decision may request an explanation, human review, correction of relevant input data, and an appeal. Human review must be meaningful, must consider the person's submission, and must not simply ratify the automated output. A safety or fraud-prevention exception may delay disclosure of details, but it does not eliminate review where the decision has material effects, unless Section 16.2 requires a temporary restriction.

Risk scores may be retained for P2 or P3 only for the period in Appendix B and only if the score remains necessary. A score derived from Behavioral Data is subject to Section 2.6 and cannot be treated as Anonymized Information without the validation described in Appendix A. The safeguards in this Section supplement, and do not replace, the consent and purpose conditions in Sections 6 and 7.

14. Children's Data

For purposes of this Policy, a user under 13 is treated as a child; a user aged 13–15 is treated as a young user; a user aged 16–17 is a youth user; and a user aged 18 or older is an adult. AetherCloud may provide P1 to a child only where a customer or parent has supplied a verified authorization mechanism, the service is appropriate to the configured age group, and Section 6's basis and Appendix C's purpose restrictions are satisfied.

P4, P5, P9, and P10 are disabled for users under 13 unless required for immediate safety or P8 legal compliance, and even then only the minimum data may be processed. For ages 13–15, P4 requires verified parental authorization or a regionally valid alternative, P5 is prohibited, and P10 may be used only for non-material safety or fraud signals. For ages 16–17, P4 may operate with the user's consent where permitted, but P5 and High-Risk Processing remain subject to the heightened safeguards in Sections 6.4 and 13.2.

AetherCloud may process age signals for safety, fraud prevention, or legal compliance without parental authorization where reasonably necessary, but may not retain the signal longer than Appendix B permits. A parental authorization does not permit Advertising or disclosure of Restricted Information. When age is uncertain, AetherCloud applies the more protective category until verification, except that an emergency safety measure under Section 16.2 may proceed on a minimum-necessary basis.

15. Security

AetherCloud maintains safeguards proportionate to classification, purpose, and risk. Restricted Information requires encryption, least-privilege access, strong authentication, logging, segregation, incident response, and periodic review. Sensitive Information requires access controls and monitoring appropriate to the threat; Pseudonymous Information requires protection of both the data and the linkage material.

Security personnel may access data for P2 or P3 where reasonably necessary to investigate an incident, but they must record the reason, limit the scope, and avoid using the information for P4–P7. Notwithstanding Section 7.2, a security investigation may temporarily correlate Device Data, Behavioral Data, and Account Data; the correlation must be dismantled when the investigation closes unless Appendix B or a Legal Hold permits retention.

A suspected incident involving Restricted Information is escalated under the incident plan, and a Service Provider must notify AetherCloud under Section 9.1. Security logs may contain Sensitive Information as an incidental consequence of investigation, but the incident team must reclassify and retain them under Appendix B where Section 11.5 applies.

16. Government and Law-Enforcement Requests

For a valid legal request, AetherCloud may disclose the minimum information legally required after verifying authenticity, scope, and jurisdiction. A voluntary request does not compel disclosure; AetherCloud may disclose only P2 or P8 information where a documented necessity exists, the recipient is authorized, and no regional rule forbids the disclosure.

An emergency request involving an imminent threat to life or serious physical safety may be handled before ordinary review, provided that the requester identifies the emergency, the disclosure is limited to necessary information, and the decision is documented and reviewed afterward. Section 11.4 may be invoked for preservation, but an emergency does not authorize unrelated access.

A cross-border request requires a jurisdictional assessment, conflict review under Section 10.2, and escalation when the source region restricts transfer. Restricted Information may

be disclosed only under a valid legal mandate, an emergency satisfying this Section, or a regional rule expressly permitting it. Where none of those conditions is met, AetherCloud must challenge, narrow, or refuse the request to the extent permitted.

AetherCloud records each disclosure request, decision, categories, recipient, and timing. Notice may be delayed or omitted when legally prohibited, necessary to protect an investigation, or inconsistent with an emergency, but the basis must be revisited. This Section overrides Section 8.

17. Cookies and Tracking Technologies

AetherCloud uses strictly necessary technologies for authentication, security, load balancing, and requested functionality. Optional analytics, personalization, and advertising technologies are enabled only according to the consent and regional settings associated with the user or device. A refusal of optional technologies must not disable an Essential Service unless the technology is technically indispensable to that service.

A cookie identifier is Pseudonymous Information when it can be linked to a user or device and is Anonymized Information only after the validation in Appendix A. Behavioral Data collected through optional technologies may be used for P4, P5, P6, or P7 only where Appendix C permits the purpose and Section 6.2's consent rule is satisfied. A customer's workspace setting cannot override a user-level regional prohibition under Section 19.

18. Policy Amendments

AetherCloud may amend this Policy by recording version, effective date, affected sections, reason, and scope. Amendments are prospective unless expressly stated otherwise and permitted by Section 20; notice does not substitute for Appendix C consent.

Version 3.0 became effective 1 January 2026 and established the original P1–P10 matrix, the 24-month Account Data default, and the initial regional framework. Version 3.1 became effective 1 April 2026 and changed Section 11.2 to an 18-month P1 Account Data period, added the billing-dispute exception, and narrowed P4 use of Sensitive Information by amending Section 7.4.

Version 3.2 became effective 15 August 2026 and replaced Section 11.2 with the 12-month rule, amended Section 13.2 to require meaningful human review for material eligibility decisions, amended Section 19.1 for EEA Restricted Information transfers, and added the Appendix B precedence note for reclassified data. Section 11.2 was replaced by the version effective 15 August 2026. Section 7.4 was amended on 1 April 2026 and was not silently restored by Version 3.2.

The former 24-month period remains relevant only to records governed by Version 3.0 or the documented billing-dispute exception in Version 3.1 or 3.2. A later amendment controls

from its Effective Date, while the rule applicable at collection continues for earlier records unless Section 11.5 requires reclassification.

19. Regional Provisions

19.1 European Economic Area. For an EEA person, Restricted Information may not be transferred outside the approved transfer set unless the transfer assessment, safeguards, and documented necessity in Section 10.4 are complete. P5 requires affirmative consent, and P10 material decisions require human review under Section 13.3. This regional rule overrides Sections 8.1 and 10.1 within the EEA.

19.2 United Kingdom. For a United Kingdom person, a Service Provider handling Sensitive Information must support deletion and access requests within the contractual service window, and P4 requires a separate consent signal from P5. A Regulatory Request is reviewed under Section 16 even if the requester is domestic. This provision narrows, but does not expand, the general rights process in Section 12.

19.3 India. For an India-based person, Account Data may be processed for P1 and P8 as stated in Appendix C, but Restricted Information exported for P10 requires senior governance approval, a necessity record, and the controls in Sections 10.4 and 15.2. Children's data follows the age rules in Section 14, except that the safer treatment applies when age evidence is incomplete.

19.4 United States. For a United States person, a verified opt-out of P5 must be honored for future Advertising processing, and an opt-out does not disable P1, P2, or P3. Sale-like transfers to an independent recipient are prohibited unless the recipient's role, purpose, and notice satisfy Sections 8 and 9. A customer administrator cannot waive an individual opt-out.

19.5 California. For a California person, P4 and P5 must be separately described in the preference interface, and a request to limit Sensitive Information use applies to Secondary Purposes unless the use is necessary for P1, P2, P3, or P8. Restricted Information may not be used for Advertising under any circumstance. This provision overrides the broader Secondary Purpose permission in Section 6.2.

19.6 Regional priority. A regional rule controls within its stated jurisdiction where it conflicts with a global rule. If the person's location is uncertain, AetherCloud applies the more protective rule until a reliable location is established, except that a documented emergency under Section 16.2 may use the minimum necessary rule.

20. Conflict Resolution and Interpretation

A specific provision takes precedence over a general provision. A later amendment takes precedence over an earlier version from its Effective Date. A regional provision takes

precedence within its stated jurisdiction. Appendix provisions control where the main text expressly incorporates them. Definitions in Section 2 control unless another section expressly provides a narrower meaning.

The following hierarchy resolves apparent conflicts: first, a mandatory regional rule; second, a later effective amendment; third, a specific data-category rule; fourth, a specific purpose rule in Appendix C; fifth, an expressly incorporated Appendix B retention rule; sixth, a Legal Hold or legally required preservation rule; and finally, the general rule. A provision is not made broader merely because a later clause uses a broader noun.

Accordingly, Section 7.1’ s general P1 retention permission yields to Section 11.2’ s amended 12-month rule; Section 8.1’ s Affiliate permission yields to Section 19.5’ s California Advertising prohibition; Section 10.1’ s transfer permission yields to Section 19.1’ s EEA restriction; Section 11.1’ s ordinary schedule yields to a narrower Restricted Information entry in Appendix B; and Section 13.1’ s permitted alert ranking does not authorize a material eligibility decision without Section 13.3 review.

A reference to a section includes its subsections and incorporated appendices unless the reference is expressly limited. A nested reference must be resolved in sequence rather than treated as a citation to the first named provision alone. Thus, Section 8.4 points to Section 9.2, Section 9.2 points to Section 2.10, Section 2.10 points to the role condition in Appendix A, and the resulting relationship controls the disclosure decision.

Appendix A — Data Classification Matrix

Data Type	Classification	Source	Sensitive?	Restricted?	Derived?	Permitted Purposes
Account identity	Personal Information	User/customer	No	No	No	P1, P2, P8
Authentication secret	Restricted Information	User/device	Yes	Yes	No	P1, P2, P3
Contact details	Personal Information	User/customer	No	No	No	P1, P2, P4 P8
Payment token	Sensitive Information	Payment provider	Yes	No	No	P1, P3, P8

Full payment credential	Restricted Information	Payment provider	Yes	Yes	No	P1, P8
IP and device signal	Personal Information	Device/app	No	No	No	P1, P2, P3 P6
Precise location	Sensitive Information	Device/connected service	Yes	No	No	P1, P2, P3
Health-related content	Sensitive Information	User-generated	Yes	No	No	P1, P2, P8
Recovery code	Restricted Information	User	Yes	Yes	No	P1, P2
User-generated file	Personal Information	User/customer	Contextual	Contextual	No	P1, P2, P7 P9
Usage event	Behavioral Data	App/cookie	No	No	No	P1, P2, P4 P6, P7
Risk score	Derived Information	Models/logs	Contextual	Contextual	Yes	P2, P3, P1
Preference segment	Derived Information	Behavioral Data	No	No	Yes	P4, P5, P6
Age signal	Sensitive Information	User/customer	Yes	No	No	P1, P2, P3 P8

Security incident record	Sensitive Information	Security team	Yes	May be	Yes	P2, P3, P8
Validated aggregate metric	Anonymized Information	Analytics systems	No	No	Yes	P6, P7, P9

For purposes of the matrix, “Contextual” means that classification depends on the content, linkability, or purpose. Restricted Information is a subset of Sensitive Information for purposes of Appendix A. A Derived Information output inherits the highest classification of its source unless validation documents why linkability and sensitivity are no longer reasonably present.

Appendix B — Retention Schedule

Data Category	Purpose	Default Retention	Exception	Controlling Rule
Account Data	P1 Service Delivery	12 months	Documented billing dispute: 24 months	Section 11.2, Version 3.2
Contact Data	P1/P2	12 months after closure	Active support matter	Section 11.1 and Legal Hold
Authentication secrets	P1/P2	Until rotation or reset	Security investigation	Restricted category controls
Security logs	P2	18 months	Legal Hold or Section 16.2	Specific schedule overrides general deletion
Fraud signals	P3	12 months	Open investigation	Purpose and hold must be recorded
Payment records	P1/P8	7 years	Shorter regional rule	Applicable legal period controls

Behavioral Data	P4/P6	12 months	Consent withdrawal: delete promptly	Section 6.2 and Section 12
Advertising segment	P5	90 days	Active consent renewal	No Restricted or children' s data
Restricted Information	P2/P3	90 days	Section 16.2 legal hold	Narrower category rule
Risk score	P10	90 days	Appeal or investigation	Section 13.4 and Legal Hold
User-Generated Content	P1	Customer-configured term	Legal hold	Customer term cannot defeat Section 19
Model training sample	P7/P9	6 months	Validated Anonymized Information	Appendix A validation required
Age signal	P1/P2/P8	90 days	Ongoing safety investigation	Section 14
Backup copy	Any	Next deletion cycle	Isolated Legal Hold copy	Section 11.6

Appendix B' s 12-month Account Data entry supersedes the earlier 18-month Version 3.1 entry and the original 24-month Version 3.0 entry from 15 August 2026. The 24-month billing-dispute value is an exception, not a replacement of the default. If reclassification under Section 11.5 places a record in Restricted Information, the 90-day entry controls from the validation date unless Section 16.2 or a mandatory legal period applies.

Appendix C — Processing Purpose Matrix

ID and Purpose	Allowed Categories	Legal Basis	Retention	Sharing Restrictions	Consent
P1 Service Delivery	Account, Contact, Content, Device	Service necessity	Appendix B	Customer/Service Provider only	No, unless regional ru
P2 Security	Device, Behavioral,	Legitimate protection/nec	Appendix B	Named security	No, unless required

	Risk, Security Record	essity		recipients	
P3 Fraud Prevention	Device, Payment Token, Risk, limited Restricted	Necessity/fraud defense	Appendix B	Fraud team and approved provider	No, unless regional ri
P4 Personalization	Contact, Behavioral, Preference Segment	Consent or configured service basis	12 months	No independent recipient	Usually Ye
P5 Advertising	Contact, Usage, validated Aggregate	Consent/opt-out framework	90 days	No Restricted/children's data	Yes where marked
P6 Analytics	Device, Behavioral, Aggregate, Pseudonymous	Consent or service improvement basis	Appendix B	Aggregated or approved provider	Contextua
P7 Product Improvement	Derived, Content excerpts, Aggregate	Consent or documented improvement basis	6 months	No raw Restricted data	Contextua
P8 Legal Compliance	Account, Payment, Security, Restricted minimum	Legal obligation	Legal period/Appendix B	Authority or legal team	No
P9 Research	Aggregate, Pseudonymous, limited Content	Consent or documented research basis	6 months	Research provider under Section 9	Often Yes
P10 Automated Decision-Making	Risk, Behavioral, Account, limited Sensitive	Necessity plus safeguards	90 days	Decision team only	Section 13 controls

Every listed matrix condition is cumulative. Derived Information reaches P7 only when its source is eligible, Section 2.6 is satisfied, and Appendix B's six-month period applies. P10

may support P2 triage, but material eligibility requires Section 13.3 review; a P1 collection history does not authorize another purpose.

Adversarial Test Coverage Map

Test ID	Relevant Section	Feature Being Tested	Expected Relationship	Expected Reasoning Challenge
T01	7.1 → 11.2	Cross-reference	PROCESSING_RULE → RETENTION_RULE	Follow amer 12-month ru
T02	8.4 → 9.2 → 2.10 → Appendix A	Multi-hop reference	SHARING → PROVIDER → DEFINITION → CLASSIFICATION	Traverse fou
T03	11.2 → 18	Temporal supersession	OLD_RULE → SUPERSEDES → NEW_RULE	Do not retur months as c default
T04	11.2, 11.5 → Appendix B	Reclassification	CLASSIFICATION_C HANGE → RETENTION_CHAN GE	Apply 90 day validation
T05	6.4 + 13.2	Conjunction	SENSITIVE_USE → CONSENT_AND_SA FEGUARDS	Both conditi are necessai
T06	8.1 → 19.5	Regional override	GENERAL_AFFILIAT E_SHARING → OVERRIDDEN_BY → CALIFORNIA_RULE	Geographic specificity w
T07	10.1 → 19.1	Regional transfer restriction	TRANSFER → EEA_OVERRIDE	Do not treat Affiliate stati sufficient
T08	11.1 → 11.4	Exception	DELETION → EXCEPTION_FOR → LEGAL_HOLD	Hold suspen deletion, no use

T09	13.1 → 13.3	Scope distinction	ALERT_RANKING ≠ MATERIAL_DECISION	Determine whether human review is mandatory
T10	14 → 6.2 → Appendix C	Children's consent	AGE_BAND → CONSENT_RULE → PURPOSE_MATRIX	Age and purpose must be joined
T11	16.1–16.4	Government-request cases	REQUEST_TYPE → DISCLOSURE_CONDITION	Distinguish between emergency, voluntary, and cross-border requests
T12	17 → Appendix A	Definition dependency	COOKIE_ID → PSEUDONYMOUS_CLASSIFICATION	Linkability of automatic anonymization
T13	2.6 → Appendix C → Appendix B	Derived-data chain	DERIVED_OUTPUT → SOURCE_ELIGIBILITY → RETENTION	Output in the source consistency
T14	8.2 → 9.1	Processor restriction	DISCLOSURE → CONTRACTUAL_LIMITS	Vendor labels are enough
T15	11.2 Version 3.1 → Version 3.2	Later amendment	18_MONTH_RULE → 12_MONTH_RULE	Apply effective date prospectively
T16	Appendix B → Section 20	Appendix precedence	RETENTION_CONFLICT → SPECIFICITY_HIERARCHY	Resolve conflicts looking at entries
T17	6.2 → 12	Withdrawal	CONSENT_WITHDRAWAL → FUTURE_SECONDARY_PROCESSING_STOP	Do not erase valid holds automatically
T18	7.4 → 19.6	Regional uncertainty	UNKNOWN_LOCATION → PROTECTIVE_RULE	Use more protective rule temporarily
T19	9.3 → 16.2	Linkage exception	PSEUDONYMOUS_LINKAGE →	Link only for documented necessity

			LEGAL_HOLD_EXCEPTION	
T20	13.2 → Appendix A	Classification inheritance	RISK_SCORE → DERIVED_INFORMATION → PERSONAL_INFORMATION	A score is no automatical anonymous
T21	8.3 → 18	Transaction disclosure	TRANSFER → NOTICE/CONSENT_DEPENDENCY	Corporate transaction blanket authorization
T22	11.6 → Appendix B	Backup deletion	ACTIVE_DELETE → BACKUP_CYCLE	Distinguish deletion from immediate e
T23	19.2 → 12	Narrow regional rule	UK_P4/P5_SPLIT → RIGHTS_PROCESS	Regional rule narrows global consent treat
T24	19.3 → 10.4 → 15.2	India Restricted transfer	REGION → TRANSFER_SAFEGUARDS → SECURITY	Three-condition export chair
T25	19.4 → 8.1	Individual opt-out	U.S._OPT_OUT → AFFILIATE_PERMISSION_LIMIT	Administrative cannot waive individual cl
T26	11.3 → 18	Collection-time temporal rule	PRE_EFFECTIVE_RECORD → HISTORICAL_RULE	Current policy not automatic retroactive
T27	2.10 → 9.2	Definition controls role	SERVICE_PROVIDER_DEFINITION → PROCESSOR_DUTIES	Functional role defeats control label
T28	5 → Appendix C	Purpose allow-list	PURPOSE_NAME → MATRIX_RELATIONSHIP	Section 5 also insufficient authorization
T29	16.5 → 11.4	Request logging and hold	REQUEST_RECORD → PRESERVATION_SCOPE	Preserve on defined material scope
T30	19.1, 19.5 → 20.1	Multiple overrides	REGIONAL_RULES →	Select jurisdiction specific control

			GLOBAL_HIERARCHY	clause
T31	Appendix A → Appendix C	Category-purpose edge	DATA_CLASSIFICATION → PURPOSE_PERMISSION	Test graph edge construction
T32	Appendix C → Appendix B	Purpose-retention edge	PURPOSE → RETENTION	Purpose-specific period may differ from category default
T33	7.3 → 2.6 → Appendix A	Definition changes interpretation	MODEL_OUTPUT → DERIVED_DEFINITION → CLASSIFICATION	Infer continuous privacy obligation
T34	11.2 → billing exception	Narrow exception	GENERAL_12_MONTHS → EXCEPTION_24_MONTHS	Detect documented condition rather than choose maximum
T35	6.3 → 19.6	Protective fallback	UNCERTAIN_CONSENT/LOCATION → MORE_PROTECTIVE_RULE	Handle inconsistent metadata conservatively
T36	13.4 → 12	Appeal mechanism	ADVERSE_DECISION → RIGHTS_APPEAL	Connect automated decision safeguards to rights
T37	14.3 → 11.7	Age-retention dependency	AGE_SIGNAL → 90_DAY_RETENTION	Safety exception does not create indefinite status
T38	8.4 → 10.4 → Appendix C	Sharing plus transfer	PROVIDER_DISCLOSURE → TRANSFER_ASSESSMENT → PURPOSE_MATRIX	Resolve provider and geographic jointly
T39	18.2 → 7.4	Superseded use rule	AMENDMENT → NARROWED_PERSONALIZATION	Version 3.1 clause remains open

T40	20.2 → 16.2 → Appendix B	Legal-preservation hierarchy	MANDATORY_HOLD → RETENTION_EXCEP TION	Legal period controls only affected rec
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End of synthetic controlled test document.

[1] <https://example.invalid/synthetic-policy>

References

[1] Synthetic internal reference for document provenance; no external legal source is incorporated.